NEIGHBOURWISE AI

Neighborhood Intelligence Report

Mattapan

Boston, Massachusetts

55.9

out of 100

▲ Strength: **Housing**

▼ Weakness: **Universities**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Mattapan, a vibrant neighborhood nestled in the heart of Boston, Massachusetts, offers a unique blend of urban living and community spirit. With a master score of 55.9 out of 100, it's a solid choice for those seeking an affordable, well-connected community. Mattapan's top strength lies in its housing, scoring an impressive 79.5. The neighborhood boasts a diverse range of housing options, from historic single-family homes to modern apartments, making it an attractive choice for families and young professionals alike. The area's architectural charm is complemented by its rich cultural heritage, creating a distinctive character that sets it apart from other Boston neighborhoods.

Mattapan's transit score of 78.0 is another feather in its cap, indicating excellent connectivity to the rest of the city. The neighborhood is served by the MBTA's Mattapan High-Speed Line and several bus routes, making it a convenient choice for commuters. The area also scores well in terms of grocery options (75.5) and schools (68.7), ensuring that residents have easy access to essential amenities and quality education. However, the neighborhood's healthcare score of 31.6 suggests that there is room for improvement in this area, a factor that potential residents might want to consider.

Despite its many strengths, Mattapan's most notable weakness is its lack of universities, scoring a flat 0.0 in this domain. This could be a significant trade-off for those seeking a neighborhood with a vibrant student population or easy access to higher education institutions. However, for those who prioritize affordable housing, good transit options, and a strong sense of community, Mattapan's charms more than make up for this shortcoming. In essence, Mattapan is a neighborhood that suits those who value a close-knit community and practical conveniences over a bustling university scene.

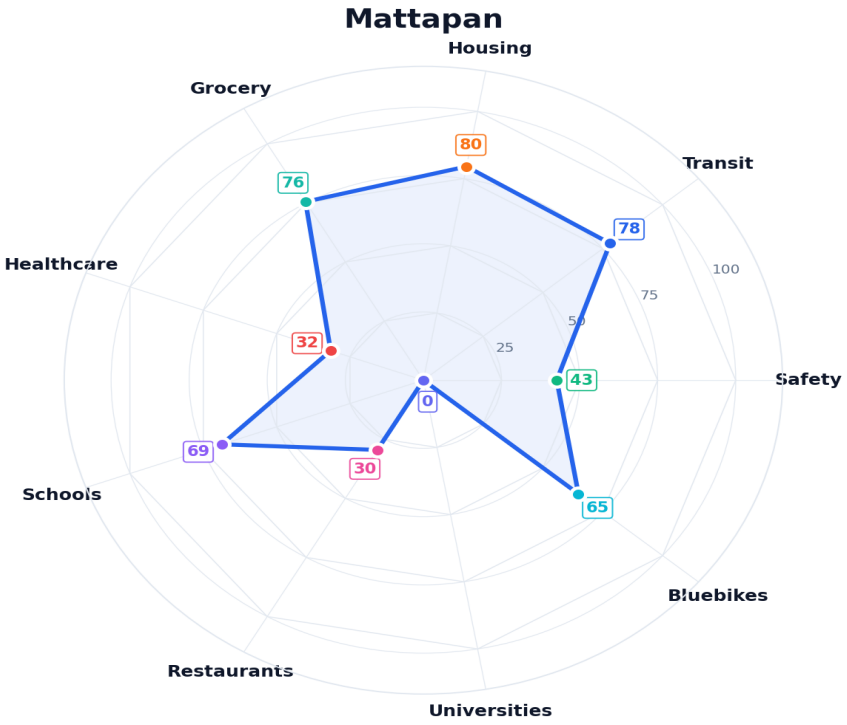
DOMAIN SCORECARD

DOMAIN	SCORE	GRADE
Safety	42.7	Moderate
Transit	78.0	Good
Housing	79.5	Affordable
Grocery	75.5	Abundant
Healthcare	31.6	Moderate
Schools	68.7	Good
Restaurants	29.5	Moderate

Universities	0.0	None
Bluebikes	64.8	Good

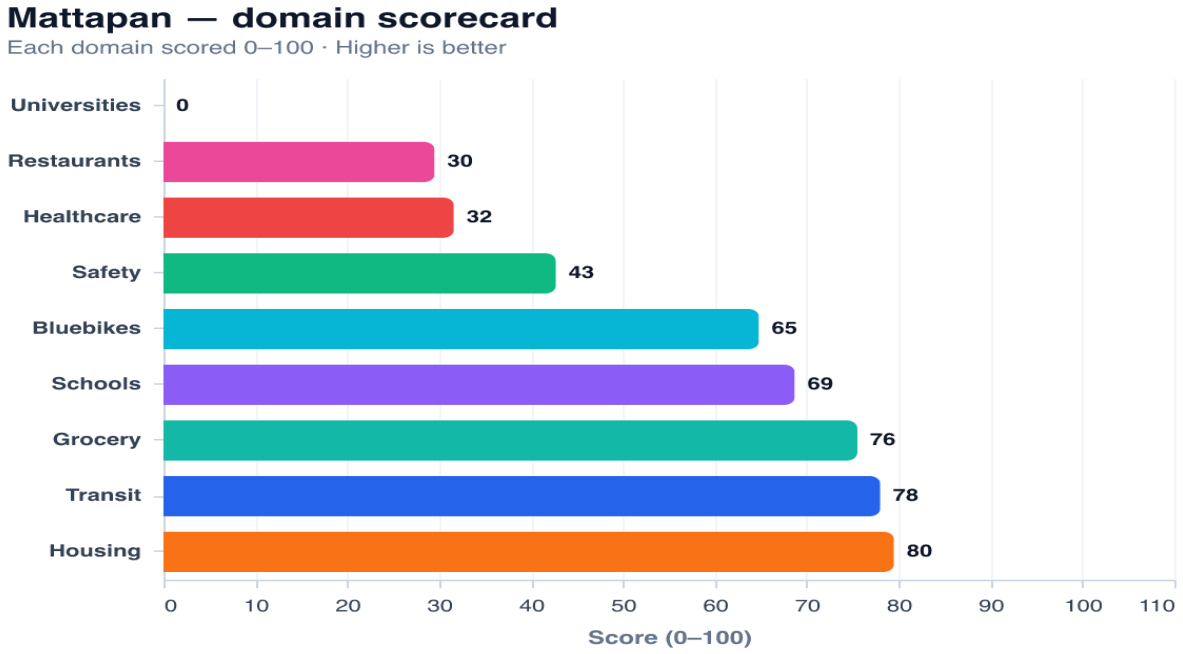
VISUAL ANALYSIS

Domain Radar



Each spoke represents one of the 9 scored domains (0–100).

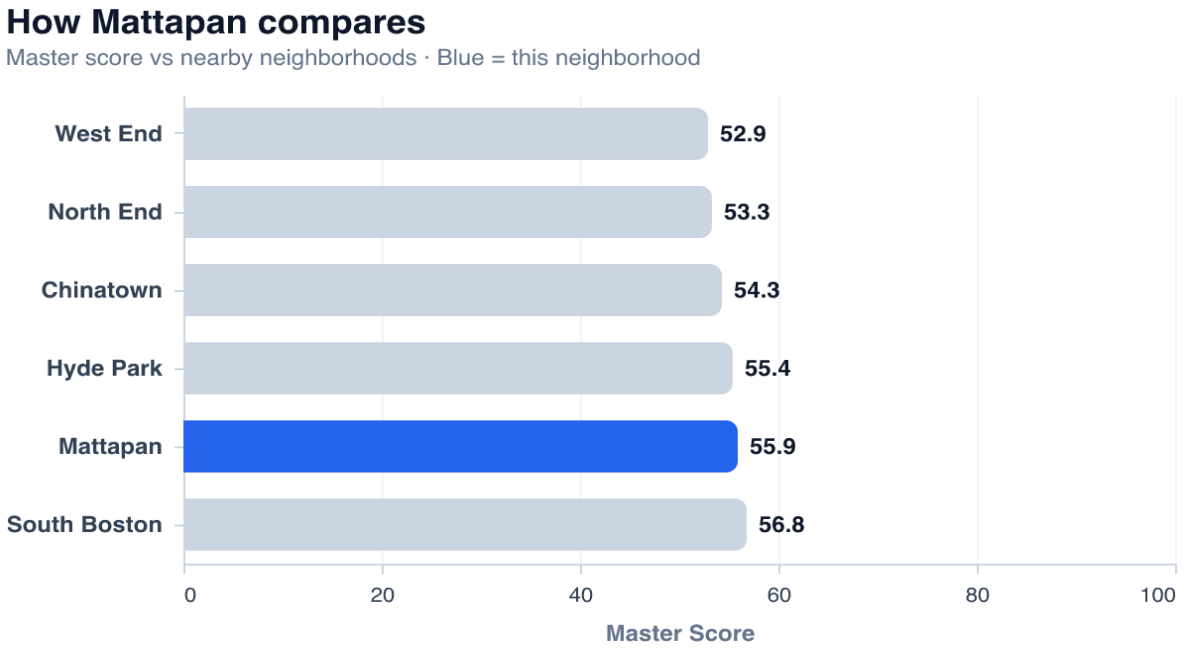
All Domain Scores



Color-coded by domain · Higher = stronger performance.

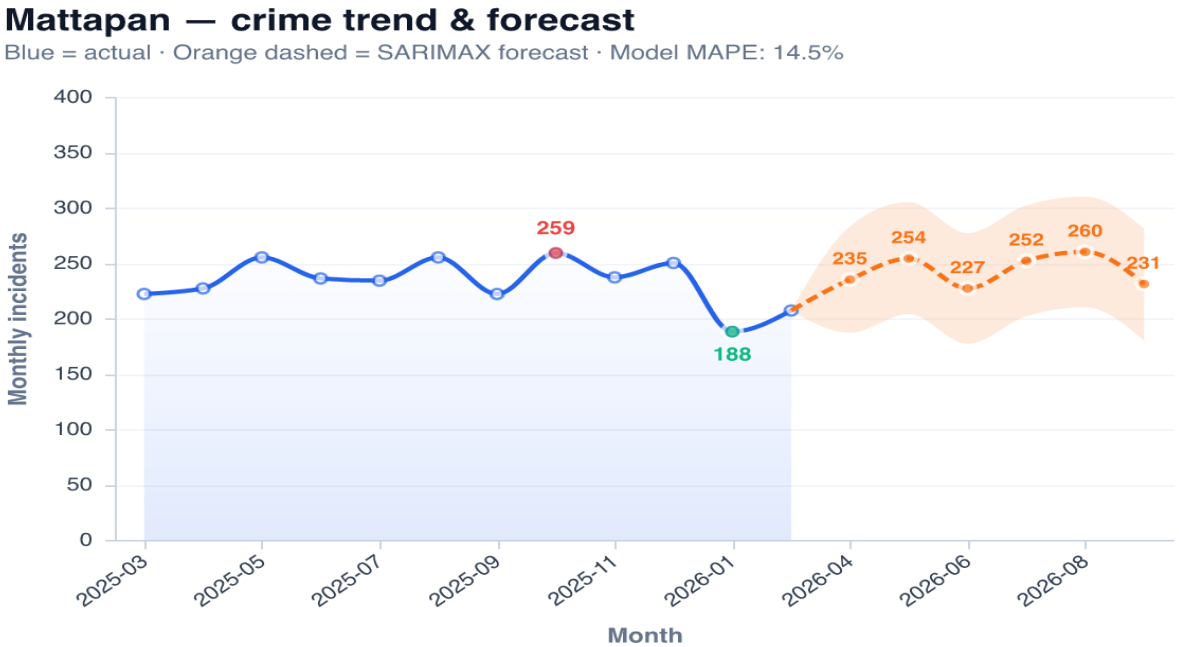
COMPARISON & TRENDS

Neighborhood Comparison



Blue bar = this neighborhood · vs 5 nearest by master score.

Crime Trend & Forecast



Blue = actual · Orange dashed = SARIMAX forecast + CI band.

Trend: Stable · Model MAPE: 14.5% · Reliability: HIGH

In Mattapan, Boston, the recent three-month crime average has slightly decreased from 210 to 207 incidents year-over-year, indicating a stable trend. However, the forecast for April 2026 suggests a potential rise to 235 crimes. Notably, 62.8% of crimes occur within 34 identified hotspot clusters in the neighborhood.

DOMAIN ANALYSIS

Safety

In Mattapan, a neighborhood within Boston, Massachusetts, safety is a moderate concern with a score of 42.7 out of 100. The most common police service call is to investigate a person; however, the most prevalent actual crime type is property crime, accounting for 13.57% of all incidents. There has been a slight increase of 1.64% in total incidents year over year, with a high density of incidents per square mile at 4287.68. Residents and visitors should be particularly aware of property crimes and take necessary precautions.

Transit

Mattapan, a neighborhood in Boston, has a good transit score of 78.0, offering residents a variety of public transportation options. The rapid transit route serving the area is the Mattapan Line, which connects Mattapan Station to Ashmont Station. In addition, there are numerous bus routes, including those connecting to Quincy Center Station, Forest Hills Station, and Ruggles Station, among others. The total number of stops in Mattapan is 71, with 69 of these being bus stops and only 1 rapid transit stop. Notably, 93.0% of these stops are wheelchair accessible.

Restaurants

Mattapan, a neighborhood nestled within Boston, Massachusetts, offers a moderate restaurant scene with a density of 51.18 eateries per square mile. The 108 restaurants present a limited cuisine diversity across three categories, with an average rating of 3.4 out of 5. Notably, 16.7% of these establishments are high-quality, and the price mix heavily favors budget-friendly options, with 66 restaurants in this category. Conveniently, 91.7% of these dining spots offer delivery services.

Universities

No universities or colleges are located in MATTAPAN, BOSTON. Residents seeking higher education would need to travel to nearby neighborhoods.

LIFESTYLE & CHARACTER

Mattapan, a vibrant neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, is distinguished by its strong community spirit and unique approach to preserving its cultural and economic diversity. The area is home to a significant population of senior homeowners, and organizations like Mattapan United have initiated conversations to educate residents about the importance of estate planning. This forward-thinking approach allows older homeowners to maintain their equity and pass it along to future generations, thereby preserving affordability for families of color and acting as a barrier to gentrification. In cases where there is no family or desire to pass the home to a family member, homeowners can leave their property to a community land trust, further bolstering the neighborhood's resilience.

Daily life in Mattapan is marked by a collective effort to improve the quality of life for all residents. The introduction of microtransit services has been a game-changer, particularly for third-shift workers, expanding employment opportunities and making critical services more accessible. This new service has opened up thousands of jobs within a 60-minute commute for residents of Mattapan and neighboring Grove Hall. However, the neighborhood still faces challenges, with only 16% of residents holding a bachelor's degree or higher, compared to the citywide average of 53.4%. Access to food is another concern, with nearby Dorchester identified as the city's second-worst food desert. Despite these challenges, Mattapan's resilient community continues to strive for improvement and equity.

WHO SHOULD LIVE HERE?

1. The neighborhood of Mattapan in Boston, Massachusetts, seems to be most suitable for families. This is primarily due to the high scores in housing (79.5) and schools (68.7), which indicate good quality education and housing options. The decent transit score (78.0) also suggests easy commuting for working parents.

2. Students and young professionals might want to look elsewhere. The lack of universities in the area (score of 0.0) could be a drawback for students, and the relatively low scores in restaurants (29.5) and nightlife might not appeal to young professionals seeking a vibrant social scene.